Pioneering geneticist

Mendel published his paper in 1866, but no one took much notice until 1900, when the botanists Hugo de Vries, Carl Erich Correns, and Erich Tschermak von Seysenegg discovered his work. Scientists then began proving Mendel's theories more widely.

Within just ten years, scientists named the pairs of factors "genes" and showed that they are linked on chromosomes. It is now known that inheritance is far more complex than Mendel recognized, but his meticulous research continues to form the basis for modern studies.